

02. Forest and Wildlife Resources

01. What is forest?

Different species of plants grown in their natural habitat covering a vast area is known as forest.

02. What do you mean by wildlife?

Different species of animals found in their natural habitat is known as wildlife.

03. What is biodiversity or biological diversity?

Different species of living organisms ranging from micro to macro.

OR

It is immensely rich in wildlife and cultivated species, diverse in form and function but closely integrated in a system through multiple networks of interdependencies.

04. Why is biodiversity important for us?

OR

Why should we conserve flora and fauna?

- [i] Biodiversity satisfies our daily needs like clothes, food, furniture, etc.
- [ii] It purifies the environment.
- [iii] It maintains the food chain.

05. Mention the steps taken by the government to conserve flora and fauna.

- Government has enacted the Indian Wildlife Act in 1972.
- They have launched projects like Project Tiger.
- Public awareness has been created regarding forest and wildlife.
- Trading of animals and commodities made up of animals and plants is totally banned.

06. What is flora?

Different species of plants found in a particular region during a particular period of time.

07. What is fauna?

Different species of animals found in a particular region during a particular period of time.

08. Why is forest important for us?

Forest is important because of the following reasons:

- [i] It is the shelter for various wildlife species.
- [ii] It has valuable herbs used for medicines.
- [iii] It holds the soil in with the help of trees leading to prevention of soil erosion
- [iv] Forests are the major source of oxygen in the world.
- [v] Forest helps in changing the climate.
- [vi] Rainfall of an area depends on surrounding forest area.

09. What is Project Tiger and why was it launched?

“Project Tiger”, one of the well-practiced wildlife campaigns in the world, was launched in 1973.

In 1973, the authorities realized that the tiger population had declined from 55000 to 1827 at the turn of the century. The major reasons for decline in tiger population are numerous such as poaching for trade, shrinking habitat, depletion of prey base species, etc. Since, India and Nepal provide habitat to about two-thirds of the surviving tiger population in the world, these two nations also target for poaching and illegal trading.

To conserve tigers, a lot of National Parks, Wildlife Sanctuary was set up. Such places are: Sunderbans National Park in West Bengal, Sariska Wildlife Sanctuary in Rajasthan, Manas Tiger Reserve in Assam, etc.

10. Give some examples of community and conservation.

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Example 1 - In Sariska Tiger Reserve, Rajasthan, villagers have fought against mining by citing the Wildlife Protection Act.

Example 2 - In many areas, villagers themselves are protecting habitats and explicitly rejecting government involvement. The inhabitants of five villages in the Alwar district of Rajasthan have declared 1,200 hectares of forest as the Bhairodev Dakav 'Sonchuri', declaring their own set of rules and regulations which do not allow hunting, and are protecting the wildlife against any outside encroachments.

Example 3 - The famous Chipko movement in the Himalayas has not only successfully resisted deforestation in several areas but has also shown that community afforestation with indigenous species can be enormously successful.

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